

MAHARASHTRA



Vidarbha

Districts: 11

Population: 2.63 crore

Area: 97,321 sq km

MPs: 10

Economy: Cotton is the dominant crop in this region. It lacks industries as well as agricultural processing units.

GUJARAT



Saurashtra

Districts: 7

Population: 1.25 crore

Area: 80,000 sq km

MPs: 7

Economy: Accounts for 52 per cent of the state's agricultural GDP. Fishing and crude oil refineries also generate revenue.

KARNATAKA



Kodagu

Districts: 1

Population: 6 lakh

Area: 1,400 sq km

MPs: None. It shares with Mysore for now.

Economy: The region, located on the slopes of the Western Ghats, is rich in coffee plantations.

WEST BENGAL



Gorkhaland

Districts: 2

Population: 30 lakh

Area: 6,450 sq km

MP: 1

Economy: The main crop is tea. Dairy-farming and floriculture are sources of revenue too. Darjeeling, a part of the proposed state, is a popular hill station.

The Gorkha Janmukti Morcha (GJM) has instantly sprung into combat mode hoping that after the announcement about Telangana, Gorkhaland will no longer be a distant dream. "This is viable. Economically, Darjeeling is the only region which shares four international borders which the state Government has made into transit points of smuggling, infiltration and trafficking. Our wealth is Rs 300 crore worth of tea and timber annually and the state does everything to ensure lower production than can be justified. We produce 7 per cent of the world's tea and 24 per cent of India's. Why do we have to allow foreign markets to make a killing out of Darjeeling tea?" argues Mahendra P. Lama, a Darjeeling scholar and vice-chancellor, Central University of Sikkim.

There is also the demand for a separate Mahakoshal carved out of the natural resources-rich but less developed region of western Orissa that has witnessed pockets of growth

BJP'S RAJIV PRATAP RUDY (CENTRE) WITH GJM PROTESTERS



the Bundelkhand Mukti Morcha. The demand for Harit Pradesh, spear-headed by RLD's Ajit Singh, bucks the trend, for it is inspired by prosperity and power play and not poverty.

Vidarbha can easily be classified as the orphaned child of Maharashtra. Infamous for a large number of suicides, the cotton-growing region has declined both economically and socially over the last 60 years. The average per capita debt of the region stands at Rs 50,000, according to a study by the National Sample Survey

Organisation (NSSO) a few years ago. But all demands for a separate state mostly come from unorganised groups or disgruntled politicians who want to be rehabilitated. "For the people of Vidarbha, Mumbai is inaccessible and politicians hailing from this region are interested in serving their own interests. The idea of a winter session in Nagpur is to discuss issues of the region but all that the Assembly has done is to discuss the Ram Pradhan Committee report," says Kishore Tiwari, head of the Vidarbha Jan Andolan.

with the commissioning of a few industries. In Madhya Pradesh, a section of the tribal activists for a separate Gondwana state proudly display their analogue clocks with the arms for hours and minutes running anti-clockwise. It's their strange way of asserting a separate identity. It doesn't matter that the clock cannot be projected any differently if it's converted to digital display. Such confusing gestures represent the fate of the movement that is different from others demanding separate statehood in many other parts of the coun-